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THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTON

MEMORANDUM OF TELEPHONE CONVERSATION

SUBJECT: Telecon with Francois Mitterrand, President of France

PARTICIPANTS: The President
Francois Mitterrand, French President
Interpreter: Carol Wolters
Notetaker: Anthony Wayne

DATE, TIME June 30, 1992, 11:40 - 11:49 a.m.
AND PLACE: The White House

The President: Francois, comment allez-vous?

President Mitterrand: Fine and you, George?

The President: I am calling you on a couple of matters. First, on the situation in Bosnia. Congratulations on your visit to Sarajevo. It took courage and what we call guts. From the TV reporter, your visit seemed to give hope to many of the citizens there. What are your impressions? (C)

President Mitterrand: First, Sarajevo is a city being destroyed. The suffering is great. People are firing at all times on civilians and on buildings. When I was there Sunday, there was a lot of firing, but I was told that this was less than usual. Because of the decisions taken by the U.N., and improvements in the situation, I was able to see and speak with a number of officials and diplomats who told me that the Serbians were willing to pull out of the airport. This is a first step at least. (C)

(The President was disconnected during Mitterrand's comments.)

The President: I am very sorry about the disconnection. I didn't get to hear all of your impressions. (U)

President Mitterrand: It's okay. In summary, when it comes to Bosnia and Sarajevo, now the U.N. controls the airport so assistance can get in. (U)

The President: Do you think they can keep it open? We were prepared to do more in the U.N., but maybe that is not needed now given what you did and other developments. (C)

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PER E.O. 13526

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President Mitterrand: For the present, Sarajevo seems to be much better off but for the war in general, we are far from the end of it. I think we will only be able to end it by organizing an international conference such as you have set up for the Middle East. (Ø)

The President: That's interesting. But do you feel that there is now no need for another U.N. resolution? (Ø)

President Mitterrand: As far as another resolution is concerned, let's speak about that Sunday night. The situation is changing given all that has been done in the U.N. and the threats of action that have been made, particularly yours. Why don't we discuss this at dinner on Sunday? (Ø)

The President: Good. We'll talk about that Sunday. We have a lot of items to discuss on our agenda. I did want to mention one point on GATT. When I talked with Helmut over the weekend, he mentioned that he had had a long talk with you in Lisbon about the Uruguay Round. I know the Danish vote created new sensitivities and that you have concerns about your farmers' reaction to a U.S. EC agreement on agriculture. (Ø)

President Mitterrand: Yes, it is true. We all have our difficulties, and the farmers are not the most willing partners. (U)

The President: Exactly. (U)

President Mitterrand: Helmut Kohl told me that Jim Baker might be coming to Europe this week. If he does, I'd be happy to invite him to stop here and to see me. (Ø)

The President: Well, we had not exactly decided yet if he would go. But if there is a way it can be helpful, he will definitely come. We were considering the possibility of another ministerial meeting in Brussels on the Round. It is definitely worth one more try before Munich. Helmut feels strongly that the Round should not dominate or diminish the Summit, and we certainly do not want to do anything that could harm the Summit. (Ø)

President Mitterrand: I am ready to meet with Secretary Baker when he comes, especially since Helmut Kohl suggested it and is so interested. (Ø)

The President: Good, I'll talk to Jim. I think it is worth doing and especially going on to Brussels for serious talks with the Commission. We need progress in agriculture but also in all the areas, including services and market access. (Ø)

Francois Mitterrand: Yes, and in any case you can be assured that we in France want to see the negotiations succeed. They are essential for starting up commerce again. But I do not know if we can find a basis for agreement. All sides have been keeping their basic agenda from the others. This makes it hard. (Ø)

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The President: But I gather from my talks with Helmut that he thinks we are close. We agree, and think it is worth a try. (Ø)

President Mitterrand: I'll be available in Paris to meet with Secretary Baker. (Ø)

The President: I hope it works out for you to come to Camp David. (Ø)

President Mitterrand: Yes, me, too. I hope you are doing well.

The President: Yes, I am in good shape physically. Politically, I am not doing as well. It's tough here. My health is fine, but this is a strange political year. We can talk more on Sunday. (Ø)

President Mitterrand: Yes, it is a difficult political year. I'll see you Sunday. Oh, I wanted to mention that if I didn't take your call on Saturday, it was because I had already started my trip to Sarajevo. (U)

The President: We understood, and it took courage to do what you did. You have my full admiration. (U)

President Mitterrand: You did much more during the war. (Ø)

The President: I don't know about that. I'll see you Sunday. (U)

Mitterrand: A bientot. (U)

The President: A bientot. (U)

-- End of Conversation --

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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL
WASHINGTON D.C. 20508

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June 29, 1992

ACTION

MEMORANDUM FOR BRENT SCOWCROFT

FROM: TONY WAYNE *EW*
SUBJECT: Presidential Telephone Call from President
Mitterrand of France on Bosnia

Attached is a memo to the President and talking points for the call from President Mitterrand Tuesday morning.

Concurrences by: Jane Holl *ll*, Barry Lowenkron *ll*, Bruce Riedel *ll*

RECOMMENDATION

That you forward the memorandum for the President at Tab I.

Attachments

Tab I Proposed Telephone Call
Tab A Points to be Made

DECLASSIFIED
White House Guidelines
E.O. 13526, SEC 3.4 (b), September 11, 2006
By *SS* NARA, Date *12/22/05*

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THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTON

DECLASSIFIED
PER NSC WAIVER 1500 2021-02
By SS NARA, Date 12/22/25

FOR: THE PRESIDENT

FROM: BRENT SCOWCROFT

SUBJECT: Telephone Call From President Mitterrand of France

DATE: June 30, 1992

PURPOSE: To brief you on his trip to Bosnia and to discuss next steps

SECURE OR OPEN: open

INTERPRETER: yes

PHONE NUMBER: Signal has it; the Elysee wants to initiate.

CONTACT PERSON: Tony Wayne 395-5646

TIME DIFFERENCE: +6

SUGGESTED TIMES: 11:30am or 11:45am (To Be Confirmed)

TOPICS OF DISCUSSION: Despite the aspect of grandstanding and his lack of prior consultation, Mitterrand has won kudos at home and abroad for his visit to Sarejevo. Mitterrand was motivated in part by domestic pressure to act and in part by a desire to show that Europeans could take the lead. Mitterrand's visit also signaled that France would no longer brook Serbian foot-dragging despite historic ties to Belgrade.

The visit seems to have contributed to positive moves on the ground. The French have sent in humanitarian supplies by plane. French army specialists and equipment to help get the airport operational are enroute if not already in place. They hope to be able to fly in additional French and Canadian troops under the UN flag to operate the airport and provide security.

Monday the French Defense Ministry briefed us on French plans and asked to set up close cooperation with us and the British for any

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military operations under UN auspices. However, we know that the French have been pushing hard in private to have the WEU assume a large role in the operation and to minimize both our role and that of NATO: they have gone to the UN Secretary General to question possible use of U-2 flights to gather intelligence, they have reportedly urged the SYG to let the WEU take charge of the operation, and they complained when it looked like we might have military air controllers on the ground in Bosnia. The French are pushing WEU to prepare an enhanced contribution for the aid effort and have blocked any formal NATO planning for a role.

We are told that Mitterrand may also raise Iraq and your invitation to Camp David. In response to Iraqi misbehavior, we have proposed additional pressure on Iraq to comply with UN resolutions and a specific demand that Iraq not use PC-7 aircraft against civilians in the south and that these aircraft be moved north or face the consequences. The French are generally favorable but think our deadline is too short. We can let that slip a bit, but we want to move quickly.

Mitterrand has accepted your invitation to dinner on Sunday in Munich. But our proposed July 26-27 for Camp David interferes with his planned visit to the opening of the Barcelona Olympics so he may suggest alternative dates.

Attachment

Tab A Points to be Made

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POINTS TO BE MADE FOR
TELEPHONE CONVERSATION WITH
FRENCH PRESIDENT FRANCOIS MITTERRAND

BOSNIA

- Congratulations on your visit to Sarejevo. That took bravery, and it obviously gave hope to many citizens there.
- Clearly, the EC decision over the weekend, combined perhaps with reports of our plans, got the Serbs thinking.
- Your visit then eliminated any lingering doubt that the West was ready to act to get the aid delivered.
- Tell me your impressions.
- We hope that Monday's UN resolution will help permit the delivery of aid under the benign conditions we all desire.
- We will do our part. We have been in touch with UNHCR on possible airlift needs and will contribute.
- We, like you, hope that conditions on the ground will remain favorable so the supplies can be delivered.
- But, as my discussions with our colleagues over the weekend and your EC meeting demonstrated, the West is now ready to act to ensure delivery of humanitarian aid if need be.
- We need to stay in close touch to assure the success of this operation. You can count on us to keep the lines open.
- From my weekend talks, it was clear that our bilateral exchanges must be reinforced by wider consultations -- in the UN, in CSCE and in NATO, which is the only forum where we can talk frankly with all of our allies.

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By SS NARA, Date 12/22/25

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CONTINGENCY UN RESOLUTION (IF ASKED)

- We have shared our draft resolution authorizing the use of further means in Bosnia with you, the British and the Belgians in New York. But we only plan to pursue this if the situation on the ground demands it.

U.S. NAVAL FORCE IN THE ADRIATIC (IF ASKED)

- We do have an amphibious force in the Adriatic at present. It was on a port call nearby, and we thought that sending it into the region would be a subtle sign of our willingness to support joint efforts to get the aid delivered.

CAMP DAVID VISIT

- I am looking forward to seeing you in Munich and am glad we will be able to talk over dinner on Sunday. I hope you can accept my invitation to Camp David.
- If June 26 and 27 are not convenient, we will look for other dates. I think it is important for us to have the opportunity for a long and relaxed discussion.

URUGUAY ROUND (IF NEEDED)

- When I talked with Helmut over the weekend, he mentioned that he had a long talk with you in Lisbon about the Uruguay Round.
- I know the Danish vote created new sensitivities, and that you have concerns about your farmers' reaction to a U.S.-EC agreement on agriculture.
- But we have much to gained by showing progress now on the Round. We should be able to do so and meet your concerns.

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- We recognize the importance of CAP reform for you and how hard it was to achieve politically. We believe the GATT accord should support and protect that reform.
- The U.S. and the other agricultural producers also need a good result on the volume of subsidized exports. As you need cover on CAP reform, we need cover on export subsidies.
- Together the U.S. and the EC should be able to find a formula which gives us what we both need in agriculture and moves us to a global agreement this year. I do not think we are far apart.
- Like you, we need good understandings on market access and services for a successful agreement.
- If we can work out agreements in principle on agriculture that should be accompanied by joint commitments to move rapidly on market access and services.
- If we work carefully, I think this can all be managed to take care of political sensitivities and still send a strong signal to our business community and our GATT partners. But I urge that we go forward now.

IRAQ (IF ASKED)

- We are very disturbed by Iraqi military operations in the south, particularly their use of fixed wing aircraft in attacks on Shia civilians.
- Experience has shown that we must react quickly and firmly to such violations of UN resolutions or there will be more violations.
- IF ASKED: We are prepared to give you more time to consider this, but it is important to move quickly.

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